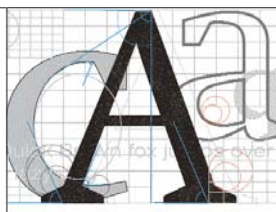




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Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Under The Radar

There's a lot of useful stuff out there—both tech and non-tech—that can make the technologically-enabled life easier. You just have to go hunting

Agent 001

We usually spend our time at *Digit* reviewing all the latest techno-wizardry, but in all this mania, we seem to have lost track of little, unappreciated things that can be so useful sometimes. So I heaved off to Mumbai's Lamington Road, and came back with these.

USB VACUUM CLEANER

Where From: Literally anywhere. I got it off a street vendor, and found it on nearly every tech-shelf I saw.

How much: Rs 120 (may vary across vendors)

Why

The vacuum cleaner comes with two attachments—a brush and a rubber tube for cleaning between keyboard keys—and a little LED to illuminate the area you're vacuuming (if you're cleaning in the dark, for whatever reason). There's also a button to switch to "high power" mode for extra suction. But don't expect a Hoover in this one—it won't remove days' worth of encrusted grime from your keyboard, but it does suck up the "invisible" dust that you don't notice till it accumulates and becomes visible. The high-power mode is a little better.

And really, you know you want your co-workers staring at you during your morning cleaning ritual.

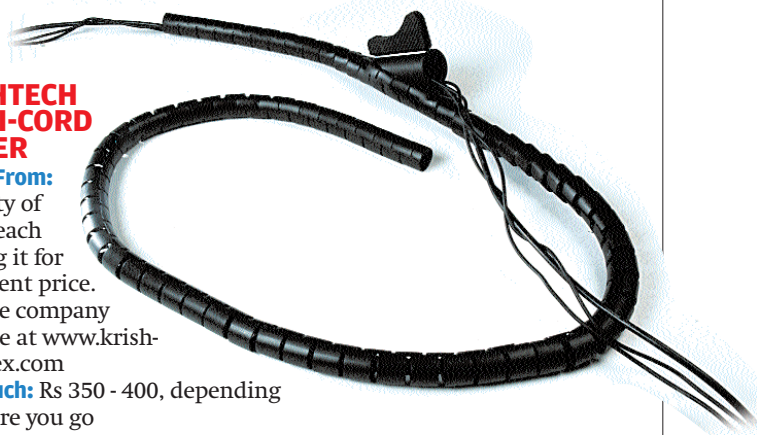


KRISHTECH MULTI-CORD BINDER

Where From:

A variety of shops, each offering it for a different price. Visit the company Web site at www.krishnainpex.com

How Much: Rs 350 - 400, depending on where you go



Why

While the price is a wee bit steep, this is an incredibly useful thing to reduce the clutter of cables behind your PC. The design is pretty ingenious too—put your wires into the clamp that comes with it and run it through the tubing that comes with it. The model here will hold all the cables you'll find behind a typical PC; you can even get a thinner version for Rs 200 that will hold all but your power cables.

COMFORTPAD GEL-FILLED MOUSEPAD

Where From: Any street vendor

How Much: Rs 20

Why

Everyone I know takes the "optical mice don't need mousepads" adage too seriously. The fact is that your hand needs a mousepad too—to shield it from your hard desk. The ComfortPad takes some fidgeting to get used to, but the unnamed goo in this thing does provide a good cushion for your wrist, especially during periods of extended mousing. The surface material works well for both optical and ball mice, and lends itself well to some casual gaming too.

